

## MODULE-II: Vocabulary & Composition

Q.1) Discuss the process of word formation.

Ans. ⇒ Words are formed by different processes. They are;

- (i) Affixation (Prefix & Suffix)
- (ii) Compounding
- (iii) Blending / Portmanteau Words
- (iv) Reduplication
- (v) Acronyms
- (vi) Clipping
- (vii) Borrowing
- (viii) Conversion

(i) Affixation: In this process words are formed with the help of prefix and suffix.

a. Prefix (affixation by using prefix): A prefix is a set of letters or syllables added in the beginning of a word.

Examples;

Prefix

Word

- intro      introvert
- pre      premature
- mis      misunderstanding
- dis      disrespect



b. Suffix (affixation by using suffix): A suffix is a set of letters or syllables added at the end of a word.

Examples;

| <u>Suffix</u> | <u>Word</u> |
|---------------|-------------|
| • ---logy     | biology     |
| • ----ex      | sender      |
| • ---or       | collector   |
| • ----ity     | ability     |
| • ----ly      | slowly      |

(ii) Compounding: In this process, new words are formed from two or more independent words.

Examples:

- Back + bone = Backbone
- Water + melon = Watermelon
- Black + board = Blackboard
- Cup + board = Cupboard
- Over + load = Overload
- White + board = Whiteboard
- Life + line = Lifeline



(iii) Blending / Portmanteau Words: In this process two words are taken and merged on the basis of sound structure and meaning.

Examples;

- Breakfast + lunch = Brunch
- Smoke + fog = Smog
- Wireless + fidelity = Wi-Fi
- International + network = Internet
- Zebra + Donkey = Zonkey

(iv) Reduplication: In this process new words are formed by doubling an entire word or a part of it.

Examples;

- Zig + zag = Zig-zag
- Criss + cross = Criss-cross
- Twinkle + twinkle = Twinkle-twinkle
- Chit + chat = Chit-chat
- Humpty + dumpty = Humpty-dumpty

(v) Clipping: In this process new words are created by shortening parts of long words.

Examples;



- Cantt - cantonment
- Lab - laboratory
- Fridge - refrigerator

(vi) Acronyms: In this process words are formed from the initials of several words.

Examples;

- RAM = Random Access Memory
- ROM = Read Only Memory
- LAN = Local Area Network
- WWW = World Wide Web

(vii) Borrowing: In this process new words are formed by borrowing words from other languages.

Examples;

- Yoga - borrowed from Sanskrit language.
- Alcohol - borrowed from Arabic language.
- Ballet - borrowed from French language.
- Karaoke - borrowed from Japanese language.
- Panda - borrowed from Chinese language.



(viii) Conversion / Zero Derivation / Functional Shift: In this process a word is assigned to a new word class or part without any change in form.

Examples;

- Cover (noun)  
Cover (verb)

- Turn (noun)  
Turn (verb)

Q.2) Write a short note on the following:

A. Synonyms

B. Antonyms

C. Homophones

D. Homonyms

A. Synonyms: Words having the same meaning are synonyms.

Examples;

- Abundance - plenty.
- Genial - warm, friendly, kindly.
- Jubilant - joyful, delighted.
- Pensive - Sad, solemn
- Ambiguous - unclear, vague, obscure.



B. Antonyms: A word opposite to another word in meaning.

Examples;

- i. Abstract - concrete, material.
- ii. Lazy - diligent, active.
- iii. Eligible - ineligible, disqualified.
- iv. Foreign - native, domestic
- v. Miser - spendthrift, philanthropist.

C. Homophones (Paronyms): Two or more words having the same pronunciation but different meanings.

Examples;

- i. Accede (Agree)  
Exceed (Surpass)
- ii. Allusion (reference)  
Illusion (a deceptive appearance)
- iii. Loose (not tight)  
Lose (be deprived of)
- iv. Assent (consent)  
Ascent (climb)
- v. Eminent (distinguished)  
Imminent (approaching)



D. Homonyms: A homonym is a word that has both the same pronunciation and the same spelling as another word. The meanings are different.

Examples;

- i. Fair - periodic market.  
Fair - light complexion.  
Fair - just.
- ii. Soil - earth.  
Soil - make dirty.
- iii. Row (Noun) - a line.  
Row (Verb) - to propel boat.
- iv. Pulse - edible seed.  
Pulse - throbbing.

Q.3) Give one word for the given expressions.

Ans.  $\Rightarrow$  One Word Substitution.

| <u>Expression</u>                          | <u>One Word</u> |
|--------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| 1- Assembly of listeners                   | 1- Audience     |
| 2- Of unknown or undeclared source or name | 2- Anonymous    |
| 3- That which has doubtful meaning         | 3- Ambiguous    |



- |                                                                                             |                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------|
| 4- The representative of one country in another                                             | 4- Ambassador   |
| 5- Government by officials                                                                  | 5- Bureaucracy  |
| 6- Living at the same time                                                                  | 6- Contemporary |
| 7- A person who regards the whole world as his own country                                  | 7- Cosmopolitan |
| 8- A speech without preparation                                                             | 8- Extempore    |
| 9- Contrary to law                                                                          | 9- Illegal      |
| 10- One who cannot pay debt                                                                 | 10- Insolvent   |
| 11- Special expressions that are used by a group and are difficult for others to understand | 11- Jargons     |
| 12- Which cannot be corrected                                                               | 12- Incoercible |
| 13- A strong desire to return to the past                                                   | 13- Nostalgia   |
| 14- Being present everywhere                                                                | 14- Omnipresent |
| 15- Being all powerful                                                                      | 15- Omnipotent  |



16- Knowing everything

16- Omniscient

17- One who collects postage stamps

17- Philatelist

18- A person who wastes money

18- Spendthrift

19- Speaking to oneself

19- Soliloquy

20- A person who never drinks alcohol

20- Teetotaler

Q.4) Give the meaning of some foreign words.

Ans. ⇒ Foreign Words.

### French Words

#### Words / Expressions

#### Meaning

1- Deja vu

an impression of having seen or experienced something before.

2- Tete--a tete

private conversation between two people.

3- Vis-a-vis

in comparison with.



- 4- Nee maiden name of a woman.
- 5- Coup de force a sudden violent action.

## Latin Words

### Words/Expressions

### Meaning

- 1- Adhoc for this (for specific, immediate purpose).
- 2- Bonafide - in good faith, sincerely.
- 3- Et cetexa and so on.
- 4- in absentia in the absence.
- 5- Lacuna an empty space or gap.
- 6- Lingua franca a medium of communication between people of different languages.
- 7- Placebo a pill having no effect except psychological.
- 8- Prima facie at first view.
- 9- Status quo the current situation.



## Greek Words

- 1- Eureka an exclamation to celebrate<sup>a</sup> discovery.
- 2- Hoi polloi the majority, the masses.
- 3- Kudos - fame from an achievement.

## German Words

- 1- Angst fear or anxiety.
- 2- Doppelganger any look-alike of a person.
- 3- Fuhrer leader.

## Italian Words

- 1- Diva a woman of outstanding talent in the world of opera.
- 2- Paparazzo a freelance photographer taking camera shots of famous people.
- 3- Viva voce by word of mouth.

## Russian Words

- 1- Perestroika political and economic reforms.
- 2- glasnost the policy of transparency.



3- TsaiKa a collection of three.

### Japanese Words

- 1- Bonsai The art of growing trees in containers.
- 2- Ikebana Japanese art of flower arrangement.
- 3- Kimono - Japanese traditional garment.
- 4- Sayonara good bye.
- 5- Hara-Kiri suicide by slashing the abdomen, formerly practiced Japan.

Q.5) What are the prerequisites/essentials of good sentences?

Ans. ⇒ A group of words that conveys a complete sense is called a sentence. A sentence is the backbone of any communication.

### Kinds of Sentences

#### Classification - I

- (a) Simple
- (b) Complex
- (c) Compound



## Classification - 2

- (a) Assertive (Affirmative and Negative)
- (b) Interrogative (Question)
- (c) Imperative (Command or Prohibition)
- (d) Optative (Wish)
- (e) Exclamatory (Strong feeling)

## Pre-requisites / Essentials of Good Sentences:

- 1- Prefer short sentences.
- 2- Be stringent with words.
- 3- Always prefer right ordering and right words.
- 4- Pay adequate attention to tense.  
Example:
  - He said that he is not feeling well. (Incorrect)
  - He said that he was<sup>not</sup> feeling well. (Correct tense)
- 5- Prefer active voice.  
Examples:
  - He has completed the work. (Active Voice)
  - The work has been completed by him. (Passive Voice)
- 6- Connectives should be used in sentences to give them a smooth flow.



7- We should avoid needless repetitions.

Examples:

→ I was born in summers in the month of July. (Needless repetition)

→ I was born in July. (A more direct sentence)

8- Avoid cluttering phrases while framing sentences.

Examples:

→ I take this opportunity to tell you that you are an excellent student.

(Use of cluttering phrase)

→ You are an excellent student.  
(Revised sentence)

9- Avoid ambiguous sentences.

Examples:

→ He noticed a large stain in the rug that was right in the center. (Ambiguous sentence)

→ He noticed a large stain in the center of the rug. (Revised sentence)

10- Avoid roundabout expressions.

Examples:

→ Person other than the primary beneficiary may not receive these dividends.  
(Roundabout expressions)

→ Only the primary beneficiary may receive these dividends. (Revised sentence)



Q.6) Write a note on precis writing.

Ans. → The art of condensation is known as precis writing. A precis of  $1/3^{\text{rd}}$  of the original draft. It is a skill which can be learnt by practice and is of immense help.

### Essential Qualities of Precis Writing:

- (i) Conciseness: Brevity is an important feature of a good precis writing. Essential information should be given by avoiding repetition and omission.
- (ii) Completeness: A precis must have essential contents without omitting any fact or idea.
- (iii) Clarity: This quality can be achieved by getting rid of circumlocution.
- (iv) Coherence: It means that one after the other ideas should be in an unbreakable chain.
- (v) Compactness: It means that all the ideas should follow a complete whole.

### Precis Writing Tips:

- Determine the theme of the passage carefully.
- Use your own language.



- Write the precis in the third person.
- Try to limit the precis to  $\frac{1}{3}^{\text{rd}}$  of the original length of the paragraph.
- Use your discretion in case of statistical information.
- Do not introduce your own ideas.
- Do not criticize or change the original resource.

### Steps for Writing a Precis

- Read the original document in order to get an overview.
- Identify the main theme of the text.
- Give a suitable short title.
- Underline the key idea. Each paragraph should have only one key idea.
- Write a note form summary of each paragraph.
- Review and edit. Compare the precis with the original text.



- Make sure that the precis is readable, concise and coherent.

Q.7) What are the different methods of paragraph writing?

Ans. ⇒ According to Dr. Henderson "A paragraph is a group of sentences relating to a single idea."

Following methods can be adopted for developing a paragraph:

① Inductive:

In this method of paragraph writing the topic sentence (the main sentence) is at the end of the paragraph. Getting the reader's attention can be difficult because the main sentence is at the end of the paragraph.

Example; "If we push a rubber ball in a container filled with water, we will feel an upward force against the bottom of the ball. This proves that water exerts pressure upwards."  
↑ Topic Sentence

② Deductive:

In this method of paragraph writing the topic sentence is in the beginning of the paragraph. The reader understands the theme easily.



Example; "Water exerts pressure upwards. If we push a rubber ball in a container filled with water, we will feel an upward force."

### ③ Linear:

The word linear means in lines. In this method of paragraph writing one sentence leads to another sentence. A logical sequence is followed.

Example; "Tin is produced from  $\text{SnO}_2$  by reducing it with carbon. The ore is crushed and washed. It is then roasted. The roasted ore is then heated with coal at 1500 K - - - - -."

### ④ Chronological:

This method of paragraph writing is based on date and time. Sentences can be arranged clockwise or anti-clockwise in a paragraph.

Example; "Before the nineteenth century people in the USA ate food only in season. But in 1810 Nicholas Appold developed the cooking and sealing process of canning. In the 1850's an American named J. Borden developed a means of - - - - -."



### ⑤ Spatial:

In this method of paragraph writing there is logical division of subject on the basis of how things are arranged in space.

Example; "High up in the atmosphere, water vapour and  $\text{SO}_2$  combine to form great banks of sulphur acid droplets. The densest clouds lie at a height of 50 km - five times higher than the highest clouds on earth. This layer is about 3 km thick and above and below are more extensive layers of acid mist."

### ⑥ Expository:

In this method of paragraph writing the topic sentence is usually the first sentence of the paragraph. This system is used to explain an operation.

### ⑦ Interruptive:

This method of paragraph writing is generally used by literary writers. It is used when sudden interruptions are introduced to give special effect to writing and speech.

### ⑧ Classification:

In this method of paragraph writing the main idea is broken into categories.



### ⑨ Cause and Effect:

In this method of paragraph writing, reasons are explained for the end results.

### ⑩ Illustration:

In this method of paragraph development, examples are provided to explain the main idea.

### ⑪ Comparison and Contrast:

This is a method of paragraph writing in which similarities and dissimilarities are brought out to develop the idea.



Q.8) What are the requisites/essentials of good paragraph writing?

Ans. ⇒ In professional writing a paragraph may consist of the following kinds of sentences:

- Main Sentence
- Major Supporting Sentences
- Minor Supporting Sentences



## Requisites / Essential of Good Paragraph Writing:

### ① Unity:

It means there should be one idea in a paragraph and every sentence of the paragraph should support and expand that idea. If a paragraph has more than one idea it is not considered as a good paragraph.

### ② Coherence:

It refers to the clear and logical linking of sentences in a paragraph. Coherence means properly connected sentences in a paragraph.

Cohesive Devices

- Pronouns (he, she, they, etc.)
- Repetition of key words & phrases
- Parallel grammatical structure
- Transitional tags (so, however, hence, etc.)

### ③ Clarity:

A good paragraph expresses the idea clearly. Clarity can be brought by using simple language and logical sequencing of sentences.

### ④ Proper length:

There is no hard and fast rule regarding the length of a paragraph. A paragraph can be short or lengthy depending on the need.



### ⑤ Emphasis:

In a good paragraph each sentence is given due emphasis.

### ⑥ Logical Sequencing:

Sentences should be arranged in a logical sequence. This brings clarity.

### ⑦ Development of Paragraph:

There are various methods of paragraph writing. The right method of paragraph development can make a paragraph impressive.

- Inductive
- Deductive
- Linear
- Chronological
- Spatial
- Expository
- Interruptive
- Classification
- Cause & Effect
- Illustration
- Comparison & Contrast.